Answer Key, Scripts for Audio Tracks and Meeting Case Studies

Unit 2: Meeting & Discussion

Task 1: Parts of formal meetings

1. E - Introductions
2. A – Reviewing past meeting/business
3. D – Beginning the meeting
4. C – Discussing items in the agenda
5. B – Finishing the meeting

Task 2: Opening a meeting

'Right, if everyone is here, (1) let's begin. I'd like to (2) start by welcoming you all to this first meeting of the Dam Project management group. As you all know, (3) the purpose of this meeting is to discuss the initial feasibility report, which was completed last week. At the end of the meeting we should have a clear idea of how to proceed, but (4) I'd like to hear what you all think before we make any decisions.

(5) As you can see from the agenda, there are four items for us to discuss. In terms of timing, I know you are all busy with other projects too, so (6)I would like to finish by 3.30.

OK, the first item on the agenda is an overview of the project plan. Tony, (7)would you like to start?

Task 3:

a. Could somebody take the minutes, please?
b. I've asked Mim to chair this part of the meeting.
c. If we don't get down to business soon, it'll be time for lunch.
d. Can't we just go round the table asking for opinions?
e. This meeting has been called to review our strategy.
f. In order to get through the agenda, I suggest we limit each item to ten minutes.
g. You should all have received a copy of the agenda.

Task 4: Model Answers

Meeting 1: OK everyone, shall we make a start? I'd like to welcome you all to this meeting. As you know, we're here today to decide on a new evaluation system for teachers of the faculty. I suggest we go round the table first to get some ideas. Then we can discuss them afterwards. Since some of us have other meetings to attend, I'd like to finish by three o'clock. So, Lisa, perhaps you'd like to start?

Meeting 2. Good afternoon everyone. Let's get started, shall we? Thank you for coming today. The purpose of this meeting is to discuss an initial plan to extend the Airlink system. As you can see from the agenda, there are five items for discussion. This meeting is due to finish at approximately five o'clock, so I would like to limit each item to 30 minutes. So, the first item in the agenda is Background.

Task 5: **Get with it**

a. get back
b. getting off
c. get on
d. get around
e. getting at
f. get through
g. get into

Task 6:

a. on to
b. on
c. up under
d. off
e. up
f. in
g. with
h. to

Task 7: Answers vary

Task 8:

1. Anne, you know what you said about
2. I'd like to point out
3. Yes, that's a good point
4. Can I say something here?
5. David, may I just finish?
6. Well, I still think the Marriott is worth considering

Task 9: Answers vary. Teacher monitors.

Task 10: (Suggested answers)

a. Is there any other business before we finish?

b. So that there's no confusion, let me summarize what we've agreed.

c. Shall I go over the main points?

d. Pam has agreed to let us have / write a report on this.

e. We've run out of time so let's stop there.

f. It looks as though we've covered the main points.

g. In that case, I declare the meeting closed.

h. I'm not sure about that last point. Could you go over it again?

i. Tom has agreed to write a report on this question.

Audio Scripts

Track 1 (task 2)

'Right, if everyone is here, (1) let's begin. I'd like to (2) start by welcoming you all to this first meeting of the Dam Project management group. As you all know,(3) the purpose of this meeting is to discuss the initial feasibility report, which was completed last week. At the end of the meeting we should have a clear idea of how to proceed, but (4) I'd like to hear what you all think before we make any decisions.

(5) As you can see from the agenda, there are four items for us to discuss. In terms of timing, I know you are all busy with other projects too, so (6)I would like to finish by 3.30.

OK, the first item on the agenda is an overview of the project plan. Tony, (7)would you like to start?

Track 2 (task 3-model answers)

Meeting 1:

OK everyone, shall we make a start? I'd like to welcome you all to this meeting. As you know, we're here today to decide on a new evaluation system for teachers of the faculty. I suggest we go round the table first to get some ideas. Then we can discuss them afterwards. Since some of us have other meetings to attend, I'd like to finish by three o'clock. So, Lisa, perhaps you'd like to start?

Meeting 2:

Good afternoon everyone. Let's get started, shall we? Thank you for coming today. The purpose of this meeting is to discuss an initial plan to extend the Airlink system. As you can see from the agenda, there are five items for discussion. This meeting is due to finish at approximately five o'clock, so I would like to limit each item to 30 minutes. So, the first item on the agenda is Background.

Track 3 (task 8)

Marc: Anne, you know what you said about the Shangri-la as a possible conference venue?

Anne: Yes, I remember.

Marc: Well, it doesn't seem so cheap to me. The delegate rate is well over 5,000 baht.

Anne: Yes, I see what you mean, but I'd like to point out the overall package they are offering. There are a lot of things included free of charge.

Marc: Yes, that's a good point, but it still seems rather expensive, I mean…

David: Can I say something here? There is always the Marriott. I've been there several times, and…

Marc: David, may I just finish? I was going to say that the overall cost per delegate at the Shangri-la is ten percent higher than what we paid last year.

David: Well, I still think the Marriott is worth considering.

Anne: Yes, that's right. It's always a good idea to get some comparative quotes but I don't think we'll do any better anywhere else.

Samples of Meeting Case Studies

Meeting Case Study #1

Your company manufactures home rice-cookers, which are very popular and sell very well in Thailand and around South East Asia. Sales have been growing steadily for the past five years, and now you are ready to move to a larger factory in Phatum Thani.

For the past 15 years, most of the assembly has been done by hand, and you employ 350 workers in your factory.

The production Manager has recently told the other managers that he has located a robotic machine that can automate most of the assembly. The robot can take over approximately 85% of the assembly process, which would increase the speed of production and decrease labor costs.

If you buy the machine, you would reduce your number of workers from 350 to only 45. The company would save approximately 36,000,000 baht per year in wages.

The equipment itself costs 100,000,000 baht.

There are number of concerns:

- Can the robot really do the job?
- Can the company afford to pay 100,000,000 baht in lump sum now?
- Do we want to lay off more than 300 workers, many of whom have been working with the company for ten years or more?

Task

1. Prepare an agenda for a meeting about this issue
2. Write an opening statement for the chairperson:
    a. Greeting
    b. Welcome
    c. State objective
    d. Explain meeting process
    e. Review agenda points
    f. Invite opinions

Meeting Case Study #2

You work for a pharmaceutical company which manufactures a liquid medicine that comes in a small bottle, with 6 bottles per box. When someone gets sick, they drink two bottles of medicine per day for 3 days.

Quality control is important, along with quantity control. Each bottle has to have the correct amount of liquid in it, and the tolerance for error is very small.

Recently, more than 15% of the production has been rejected at the quality control stage for having the wrong amount of liquid medicine inside. This is the *second time* in six months that this problem has occurred, and it is very costly for the company, as the faulty bottles and medicine have to be thrown away.

The problem lies with an automated machine that fills the bottles. Over time, the machine loses accuracy in its calibration. Company procedures call for the machine to be checked every 24 hours, and for the engineer who checks it to make any necessary adjustments to the calibration.

The logbook indicates that the checks and re-calibration have been done every day, on schedule. You're not sure what the problem is. Some possibilities:

- The machine has problems that cause the calibration to go wrong in less than 24 hours.
- The engineers responsible for re-calibrating the machine aren't doing it right.
- The engineers responsible for re-calibrating the machine have been signing the logbook, but not actually checking the machine.

Whatever the problem is, it needs to be identified and fixed immediately. The most recent problem cost the company nearly 4 million baht in lost production, and the CEO isn't happy.

Task

1. Prepare an agenda for a meeting about this issue
2. Write an opening statement for the chairperson
3. Select a chairperson

4 Run a 15-minute meeting to discuss the problem and create an action plan

Meeting Practice: **Video A – Tacoma Narrows Bridge Disaster**

Situation:

Your group is a committee of government officials and managers from the company that designed and built the Tacoma Narrows Bridge.

The bridge has been open only a few days, but it's clear that the bridge sways and moves a lot when there is a moderate to strong wind.

A meeting has been called to assess the situation and decide what action to take, if any.

Task:

- Hold a meeting in which you discuss the following agenda.
- Each participant in the meeting should have a role as either (a) government officials; or (b) company manager. The chairman should be a government official.
    - Government officials should be primarily concerned with public safety and the millions of dollars paid for the bridge.
    - Company managers should be primarily concerned with protecting the reputation of the company.
- Use the vocabulary and information you learned from watching the video.
- Your entire meeting must be held in English; no Thai.
- By the end of the meeting, you should decide on an action plan to deal with the situation.

***Remember, this meeting is being held shortly after the bridge opened – no one in the meeting knows yet for sure that the bridge will collapse in November. Making the decision to close the bridge would embarrass both the government (who paid millions of dollars for its construction) and the company (who designed and built it).*

Agenda

1. The bridge moves when the wind is strong. What is the reason for this?

2. Length of the bridge isn't the issue. There are other longer bridges in the US that don't have this problem. Which bridges are they? Can we learn anything from comparing them with the Tacoma Narrows Bridge?

3. Is this a dangerous situation, or is it normal?

4. What are the potential dangers, If any?

5. What action should be taken to protect the public?